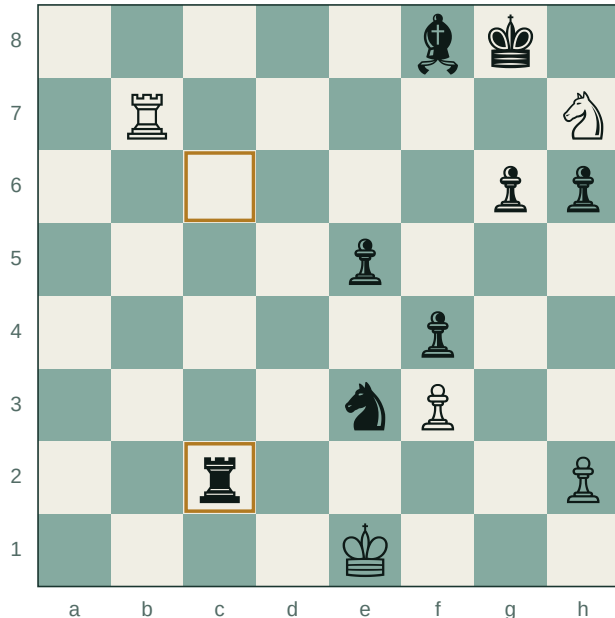


# Arabian mating nets: White, move 44

Arabian mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 43...Rc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**44. Nf6+ Kh8 45. Rh7#**

**44.Nf6+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **44...Kh8**.

**45.Rh7#** Mate: rook on h7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A mating label describes a recurring arrangement, not a substitute for checking the exact legal defenses on this board.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

In an Arabian-type net a rook and knight cooperate near a corner. One piece gives check while the other protects the rook or controls escape squares.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for a cornered king, a rook entry, and a knight square that links protection with restriction.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.